UNIT PLAN – Music

CLASS: Form 4, Term 3

UNIT: Harmony: Chord Qualities and Triads Through Aural Learning and Technology Integration

GOALS: This unit should help student to:

- Identify the qualities of triads (major, minor, diminished and augmented) by listening and from notation.
- Construct triads on any root using interval structures.
- Use the circle of fifths and key signatures to work out chords in major keys.
- Describe the mood and function of different chords and progressions.
- Harmonise a simple melody using primary chords (I, IV and V).
- Perform chords and progressions on the keyboard individually and collaboratively.
- Develop technological competence through digital tools (Coggle and Kahoot).
- Foster confidence, collaboration and appreciation for harmony.

Skills, Knowledge, Attitudes and Values

Skills:

- Aural identification of chords
- Constructing triads
- Keyboard chord playing
- Notation
- Harmonisation
- Critical listening
- Digital tools

Knowledge:

- Triads: root, third, fifth
- Interval qualities in triads
- Four chord qualities
- Triads in major keys
- Primary chords I, IV, V
- Chord symbols

Attitudes and Values:

- Collaboration
- Confidence
- Appreciation
- Perseverance
- Respect

RATIONALE:

Harmony helps students understand why music sounds the way it does, and it underpins CSEC work in analysis, composition and performance. Form 4 students have already studied intervals and their qualities (major, minor, perfect, augmented and diminished) and the circle of fifths. However, chords can still seem like shapes to memorise rather than something students can work out for themselves. This unit links what students already know about intervals to the structure of chords, so that they can build, identify and use chords with understanding.

This unit adopts an aural-first, scaffolded approach in which students hear the difference between chord qualities, work out how each is built from intervals, and then apply this in notation, keyboard performance and the harmonisation of a melody. Technology supports understanding and feedback: Coggle is used for collaborative concept mapping, which makes the structure of chords visible, and Kahoot gives quick digital assessment. Optional use of Audacity allows students to record and compare chords.

The unit aligns with the CSEC Music syllabus (theory, performance and composition) by promoting:

- Musical literacy
- Performance
- Aural perception
- Technological competence
- Problem-solving
- Collaboration

Concepts to be taught: (Concept map /Graphic organiser)



Unit Content

The table below contains the following information:

- Lesson number in unit plan
- Lesson content
- Key Concepts to be taught in the lesson
- Learning outcomes
- Values and attitudes
- Resources needed for each lesson
- Teaching and learning activities
- Assessment strategies

CONTENT	Key concepts in the lesson	Learning outcomes: Students will be able to	Values and attitudes	RESOURCES	TEACHING/LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ASSESSMENT strategies
Lesson 1: Chord Qualities: Major, Minor, Diminished and Augmented Triads	• Triad (root, third, fifth) • Stacked thirds • Chord quality	• Define a triad and state the intervals above the root for each of the four qualities. • Construct and name major, minor, diminished and augmented triads on C, G and F. • Explain how changing the third or fifth changes the quality. • Play and identify the four qualities by ear.	• Collaboration • Confidence	• Keyboard • Coggle • Kahoot • Mini whiteboards • Student devices	• Aural hook: same root, four sounds • Teacher modelling of interval structures • Collaborative Coggle concept map • “Name that chord” and keyboard practice • Kahoot quiz	• Observation • Coggle map check • Kahoot quiz (5 marks)

Lesson 2: Triads in Major Keys	• Diatonic triads • Roman numerals • Key signatures	• Construct triads on each degree of a major scale. • State the quality of each (I, ii, iii, IV, V, vi, vii°). • Use key signatures and the circle of fifths to find the notes.	• Perseverance • Collaboration	• Keyboard • Manuscript paper • Coggle map (extended) • Chord chart	• Review of Lesson 1 • Building scale-degree triads in C and G major • Extending the Coggle map • Aural identification	• Worksheet • Observation • Whiteboard check
Lesson 3: Primary Chords I, IV and V	• Primary chords • Chord symbols • Keys on the circle of fifths	• Identify and construct I, IV and V in C, G, F and D major. • Play I–IV–V–I on the keyboard. • Describe the role of each chord.	• Confidence • Appreciation	• Keyboard • Manuscript paper • Speakers	• Listening to chord examples • Guided practice at the keyboard • Pair work in several keys	• Performance observation • Short written check
Lesson 4: Chord Progressions and Cadences	• Progressions • Perfect, plagal, and imperfect cadences	• Identify cadences by ear and in notation. • Describe how cadences end musical phrases. • Write a short progression ending with a cadence.	• Appreciation • Respect	• Keyboard • Speakers • Devices • Worksheet	• Listening and discussion • Cadence identification activities • Writing and playing progressions	• Worksheet • Observation
Lesson 5: Harmonising a Melody	• Choosing chords • Primary chords • Chord symbols	• Select I, IV and V to fit a given melody.	• Collaboration • Creativity	• Short melodies • Keyboard	• Teacher modelling • Pair harmonisation • Playback and discussion	• Harmonisation task • Peer feedback

		• Write chord symbols above the melody. • Play the melody with chords.		• Manuscript paper		
Lesson 6: Triads in Minor Keys	• Relative minor • Harmonic minor i, iv, and V	• Construct triads in a minor key. • State the quality of i, iv and V. • Compare major and minor key chords.	• Perseverance • Confidence	• Keyboard • Coggle map (extended) • Manuscript paper	• Guided discovery using the circle of fifths • Keyboard practice • Aural comparison	• Observation • Worksheet
Lesson 7: Aural Identification and Revision	• Chord quality • Progressions • Cadences	• Identify chord qualities, progressions and cadences by ear. • Revise the construction of triads.	• Perseverance • Collaboration	• Keyboard • Speaker • Kahoot • Audacity (optional)	• Aural tests • Revision stations • Optional: record and compare chords in Audacity	• Aural test • Kahoot revision game
Lesson 8: Unit Assessment	• Evaluation • Harmonisation	• Complete a written test on triads, chord qualities and progressions. • Harmonise and perform a short melody.	• Pride • Responsibility	• Test paper • Keyboard • Rubric	• Written test • Practical performance • Reflection	• Written test • Practical rubric • Reflection